



Review

Machine learning techniques for detecting electrode misplacement and interchanges when recording ECGs: A systematic review and meta-analysis

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ABSTRACT

Introduction: Electrode misplacement and interchange errors are known problems when recording the 12-lead electrocardiogram (ECG). Automatic detection of these errors could play an important role for improving clinical decision making and outcomes in cardiac care. The objectives of this systematic review and meta-analysis is to 1) study the impact of electrode misplacement on ECG signals and ECG interpretation, 2) to determine the most challenging electrode misplacements to detect using machine learning (ML), 3) to analyse the ML performance of algorithms that detect electrode misplacement or interchange according to sensitivity and specificity and 4) to identify the most commonly used ML technique for detecting electrode misplacement/interchange. This review analysed the current literature regarding electrode misplacement/interchange recognition accuracy using machine learning techniques.

Method: A search of three online databases including IEEE, PubMed and ScienceDirect identified 228 articles, while 3 articles were included from additional sources from co-authors. According to the eligibility criteria, 14 articles were selected. The selected articles were considered for qualitative analysis and meta-analysis.

Results: The articles showed the effect of lead interchange on ECG morphology and as a consequence on patient diagnoses. Statistical analysis of the included articles found that machine learning performance is high in detecting electrode misplacement/interchange except left arm/left leg interchange.

Conclusion: This review emphasises the importance of detecting electrode misplacement detection in ECG diagnosis and the effects on decision making. Machine learning shows promise in detecting lead misplacement/interchange and highlights an opportunity for developing and operationalising deep learning algorithms such as convolutional neural network (CNN) to detect electrode misplacement/interchange.

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Introduction

The Electrocardiogram (ECG) represents the electrical activity of the heart as it is sensed by electrodes that are placed on the surface of the torso and limbs. The standard 12-lead ECG is the most commonly used method for heart rhythm analysis and it remains a cost-effective and efficient diagnostic tool [1]. Precise electrode placement when recording an

ECG is very important as it is directly linked to the reliability and integrity of the signals that are interpreted to inform patients diagnostics and treatment [2–4]. There are two types of electrode placement errors, namely 1) electrode misplacement (e.g. precordial electrodes are misplaced in the wrong intercostal space) and 2) electrode interchange (e.g. the left arm electrode is placed on the right arm and vice versa).

ECG signals that are recorded using misplaced electrodes can lead to significant diagnostic errors made by physicians or computer-based algorithms that can exhibit false positive diagnoses of anterior infarction, ventricular hypertrophy, ischemia, or Brugada syndrome [5]. One study suggests that's electrode misplacement can lead to false diagnoses in

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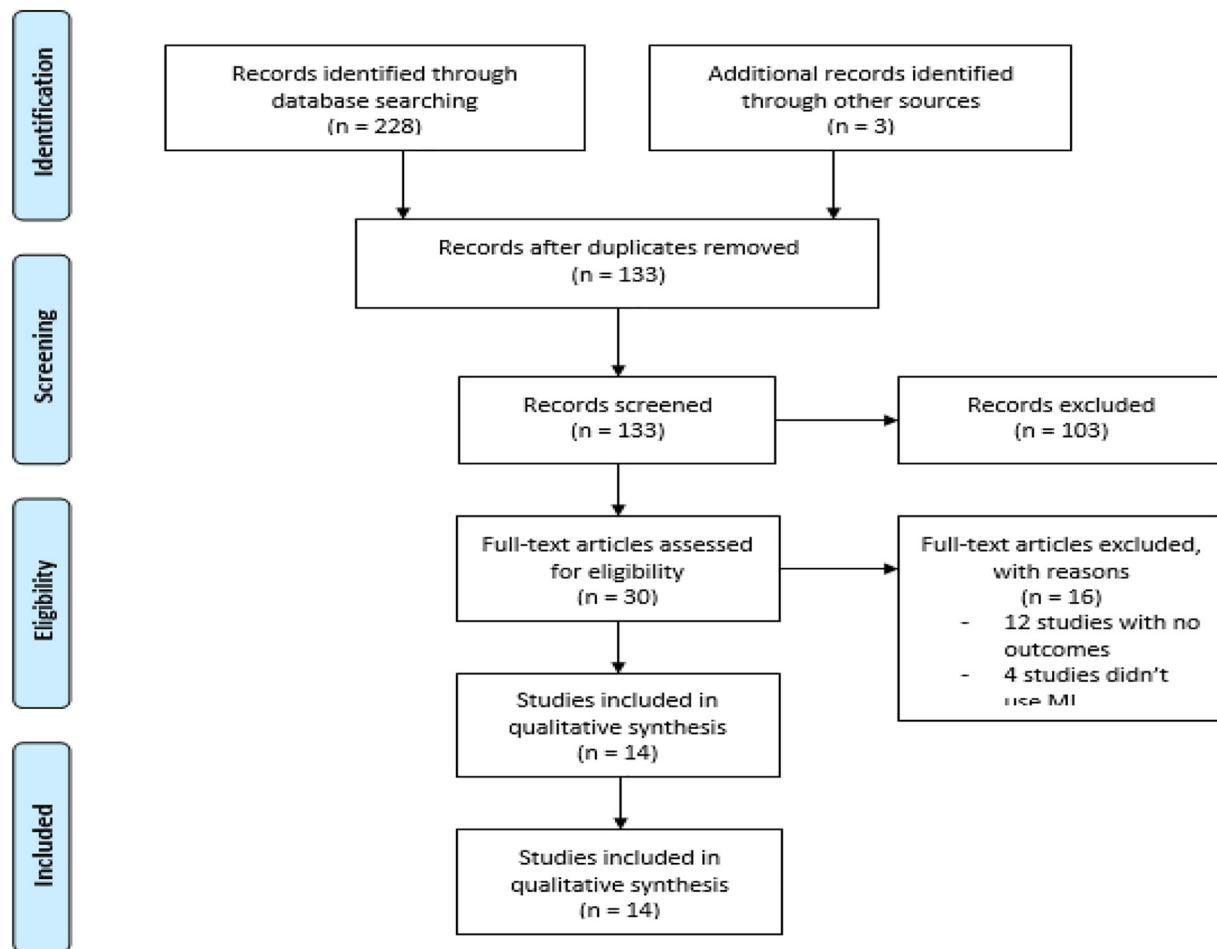


Fig. 1. PRISMA flow diagram of literature search strategy and selection.

17–24% of patients [6]. Tomasic et al. [7] reported that 12-lead ECGs are less reliable if electrodes were misplaced, but also suggest that misplacement of up to 1 cm does not have a significant effect on the ECG. However, further work is needed to assess the impact of misplaced electrodes on the diagnostic sensitivity and specificity. The 12-lead ECG has a limited sensitivity (30–70%) and specificity (70–95%) to detect acute coronary syndromes (ACS), which can look normal in most ACS for many reasons, one of which is electrode misplacement which can arise from mistakes made by clinicians [2,4]. Misplacement effects on synthesized 12-lead ECGs have been shown to cause differences in ECG interpretation. Body surface potential maps (BSPM) were used for the purpose of mimicking electrode misplacement in the 12-lead ECG, for example Kania et al. [2] focused on studying the influence of precordial electrodes misplacement on P-wave morphology. ECG electrode interchange has been extensively studied for limb leads, such as the recognition of left leg (LL) and left arm (LA) reversal which is the most challenging limb lead interchange to detect. This lead interchange can conceal ECG abnormalities and might influence wrong therapy decisions [8]. The right arm (RA)/LL reversal in normal patients can create an ECG pattern suggestive of inferior wall MI and a non-sinus atrial rhythm. The RA/right leg (RL) reversal has been reported to create a unique pattern of low voltage in the limb leads [9]. Electrode misplacement can conceal myocardial infarction or simulate a lateral wall MI in a true case of inferior wall MI [10]. Some of the aforementioned scenarios can lead to inappropriate diagnoses of STEMI patients [11]. Electrode misplacement is common even among experienced ECG technicians [12]. Finlay et al. [13] studied the effect of

electrode misplacement on the EASI-derived 12-lead ECG system. They considered healthy, MI, and LVH subjects. They found that the EASI leads are less sensitive to electrode misplacement than the standard precordial leads.

Several methods have been suggested to improve electrode placement such as the electrode misplacement simulator (EMS), which is a web-based simulation that was developed to help train healthcare professionals in placing electrodes and to assist researchers to find new criteria or features that helps in the detection of electrode misplacement [14]. Beyond better training, researchers have also suggested the use of electrode belts, for example Bond et al. [15] evaluated the Cardio Quick Patch or CQP to help clinicians to accurately positioning chest electrodes during ECG acquisition recording. CQP significantly improved the accuracy of placing precordial electrodes V1, V3–V6 with little additional effort. Van Dam et al. [16] developed camera-based system using a KINECT depth camera to record the electrode positions. However, a large database is needed to calculate the sensitivity and specificity to determine accurately misplaced leads. Ultimately, to place the ECG electrodes correctly, a computed tomography (CT) can be used while recording and ECG but this requires a costly CT scan and an increase in radiation dose [2,3]. In this paper, we conduct the first systematic review and meta-analysis on the topic of electrode misplacement/interchange detection using machine learning to show the importance of electrode misplacement/interchange detection and the performance of machine learning (ML) to detect misplacement. This paper addresses the following research questions:

Table 1
Comparison between studies.

Ref	Dataset	Leads	Feature	Method	Sensitivity	Specificity
Han C. Et al., [22]	Body surface potential maps and Physionet PTB diagnostic ECG database	LA-RA and RA-LL using conventional and Mason Likar electrode placements	P-wave frontal axis, P-wave clockwise vector loop rotation direction, QRS frontal axis, QRS clockwise vector loop rotation direction, R-wave amplitude and T-wave amplitude from lead I and lead II.	DT	Conventional ECGs (LA-RA = 91.3%, RA-LL = 72.8%) and ML ECGs (LA-RA = 88.9%, RA-LL = 75.9%)	Conventional ECGs (LA-RA = 97.9%, RA-LL = 97.5%) and ML ECGs (LA-RA = 96.5%, RA-LL = 98.5%)
Gregg R. et al., [29]	Adult 12-lead ECGs from a single teaching hospital	RA-RL and LA-RL	Maximum and minimum QRS and T-wave voltages for ECG leads I, II and III.	DT Haisty	RA-RL 84.2% LA-RL 86.6% RA-RL = 93.5% LA-RL = N/A	RA-RL 99.9% LA-RL 99.9% RA-RL = 99.4% LA-RL = N/A
Jekova I. et al., [26]	PTB diagnostic ECG database and the Common Standards for Electrocardiography (CSE) database	Precordial lead swaps over V1-V6	QRS boundaries and QRS-T pattern (QRS onset to QRS offset + 350 ms)	Correlation	95.7% (training) and 95% (testing)	93.5% (training) and 91% (testing)
Hedenet al., [17]	ECGs recorded at the emergency department at the University hospital in Lund	LA-LL and RA-LL	ECG signal	ANN	LA-LL 57.6% RA-LL 80.5%	LA-LL 99.97% RA-LL 99.95%
Jekova I. et al., [25]	CinC Challenge 2011 dataset available from PhysioNet	Chest leads and for peripheral leads	P-QRS-T amplitudes and polarities in I, II, III	Correlation	96.8% for peripheral leads and 87% for chest leads	97.8% for peripheral and chest leads
Janet al., [21]	The CSE database	RA-LA V1-V2 V5-V6 RA-LL V1-V3 V3-V4 LA-LL V2-V3 V4-V5 LL-RA-LA LA-LL-RA V4-V5-V6-V1-V2-V3 V6-V5-V4-V3 V2-V1	Correlations between leads	DT	Chest leads 93.2% and limb leads 81.5%	Chest leads 99.8% and limb leads 99.8%
Hanet al., [30]	Body surface potential maps and Physionet PTB diagnostic ECG database	LA-RA, RA-LL, V1-V2, V1-V3, V2-V3, V3-V4, V4-V5, V4-V6, V5-V6, and no lead swap)	Including both morphology features and redundancy features	SVM	Precordial cable interchanges were 56.5% and limb cable interchange (excluding left arm-left leg interchange) were 93.8%	Precordial cable interchange was 99.9%, and limb cable interchange (excluding left arm-left leg interchange) was 99.9%.
Jekova I. et al., [27]	Database from the Basel University Hospital, Physionet PTB diagnostic ECG database and the CSE diagnostic database	15 possible pairwise reversals in standard precordial leads	Morphology features	Correlation	Chest electrodes 97.9% and limb electrodes 97.4%	Chest electrodes 97.4% and limb electrodes 99.2%
Bieet al., [28]	Large (N18,000) hospital database for which serial ECG's were available and was based on simulated juxtaposition	RA-LA, V1-V2 LA-LL, V2-V3 RA-LL, V3-V4 LA-RL, V4-V5 RA-RL, V5-V6	P, Q, R, and S amplitudes	Algorithm is based on QRS axis and P amplitudes for limb electrode reversals, and PQ-RS amplitude distances	Chest electrodes 88.7% and limb electrodes 54.6%	Chest electrodes 99.8% and limb electrodes 99.6%
Korset al., [20]	Database of 1,220 standard 12-lead ECGs collected in the Common Standards for Quantitative ECG project	RA-LA, V1-V2, V3-V4, V5-V6 RA-LL, V1-V3, V4-V5 LA-LL, V2-V3, V4-V6	Averaged representative beats	DT	RA-LA 99.3%, V3-V4 99.3% RA-LL 98.3%, V4-V5 98.3% LA-LL 53.6%, V4-V6 87.2% V1-V2 98.3%, V5-V6 90.6% V1-V3 97.5%, V2-V3 95.6% 95%	RA-LA 100%, V3-V4 100% RA-LL 100%, V4-V5 100% LA-LL 95.6%, V4-V6 99.5% V1-V2 100%, V5-V6 99.8% V1-V3 100%, V2-V3 99.5% 99.95%
Hedenet al., [18]	The study was based on 11,432 ECGs	RA-LA	P, QRS, and ST-T measurement	ANNs		
Hedenet al., [19]	11,432 ECGs, The emergency department at the University Hospital in Lund	LA-LL, V3-V4 V1-V2, V4-V5 V2-V3, V5-V6	QRS amplitude and Area	ANNs	LA-LL 57.6%, V3-V4 77.5% V1-V2 80.6%, V4-V5 83.0% V2-V3 44.5%, V5-V6 73.2%	LA-LL 99.97%, V3-V4 99.95% V1-V2 99.9%, V4-V5 99.95% V2-V3 99.87%, V5-V6 99.88%
RjoobET AL., [23]	Body surface potential maps and Physionet PTB diagnostic ECG database	V1 and V2 vertical misplacement	Morphological features (P, Q, R, S and T amplitudes), statistical features and WT	SVM, DT and logistic regression	V1 89.8% V2 86.6%	V1 88.5% V2 86.6%
Rjoob K. ET AL., [24]	Body surface potential maps and Physionet PTB diagnostic ECG database	V1 and V2 vertical misplacement	Morphological features (P, Q, R, S and T amplitudes), statistical features, correlation coefficients and WT	SVM, DT, logistic regression and bagged decision tree	V1 and V2 93.3%	V1 and V2 92.0%

Decision tree (DT), Support vector machine (SVM), Artificial neural networks (ANN), Electrocardiogram (ECG), Right arm (RA), Left arm (LA), Left leg (LL), Right leg (RL), Common standards for electrocardiography (CSE), Computing in cardiology (CinC).

1. Why detecting electrodes misplacement is important? and how interpretation could be affected by electrode misplacement/interchange?
2. What are the most sensitive electrodes regarding misplacement and what are the most frequently misplaced electrodes?
3. How ML has performed to detect misplacement? And what are the most frequently used ML techniques used to detect electrode misplacement?
4. What is the best ML algorithm to detect misplacement? And what are the most challenging electrode misplacements to detect using ML?

Methods

Literature search strategy

This systematic review paper was carried out according to the preferred reporting items for systematic reviews and meta-analyses (PRISMA) guidelines to identify all relevant studies. The literature search strategy was designed to investigate ECG electrode misplacement or lead interchange recognition using machine learning techniques. Online searches were performed using PubMed, IEEE and ScienceDirect databases from their dates of inception to September 2019 by two independent reviewers (Rjoob, Iftikhar). Search terms “ECG”, “lead”, “electrode”, “cable”, “displacement”, “misplacement”, and “interchange” were combined as keywords in different sequence of combination in order to achieve maximal search sensitivity.

Selection criteria

To screen all downloaded articles, inclusion criteria were used with the following conditions: 1) original studies in ECG lead misplacement recognition that are written in English, 2) clearly defined ECG dataset, features, method for misplacement detection, 3) type of electrode misplacement (vertical chest electrode misplacement, chest electrode switching or limb leads reversal/interchange). Studies were excluded if they did not use machine learning to detect misplacement or if the study did not clarify the ECG dataset or patient diagnosis. Two reviewers applied screening to avoid bias in the inclusion or exclusion process.

Data extraction

Data were extracted from each article using texts, figures and tables with any assessment made based on the extracted data. Two reviewers (Rjoob, Iftikhar) reviewed each article; any inconsistency was resolved by discussion to reach unanimity. Primary outcomes consisted of ECG types, features, machine learning algorithm, and the database details. Secondary outcomes included performance outcomes as measured by sensitivity and specificity.

Results

Literature search

The database searches identified a total of 228 articles, while 3 articles were included from additional sources. A total of 98 duplicate articles were removed and the remaining studies were subject to primary screening based on title and abstract. After the first primary screening, 105 articles were removed, and 28 studies underwent full review. Fourteen articles were included in the final qualitative synthesis and quantitative synthesis. There are differences between studies based on the type of electrode placement error (chest or limb) and the features and machine learning algorithms being used. Fig. 1 shows literature search using PRISMA guidelines. The included 14 studies for review are divided between four regions: 1) The USA ($n = 4$), 2) Sweden ($n = 3$), 3) Switzerland and Bulgaria ($n = 3$), 4) UK ($n = 2$) and 5) Netherlands ($n = 2$). The individual characteristics of included studies are summarized in Table 1.

Study characteristics

The fourteen studies used and evaluated ML based algorithms to detect electrode misplacement/interchange, and four ML models included artificial neural networks (ANNs) ($n = 3$) [17–19], decision trees (DT) ($n = 5$) [20–24], correlation ($n = 3$) [25–27], amplitude threshold ($n = 1$) [28], haisty ($n = 1$) [29] and support vector machines (SVM) ($n = 3$) [23,24] [30]. The plurality of the studies ($n = 7$) focused on both limb and chest lead interchanges while other studies ($n = 4$) focused on limb lead interchanges only, two studies considered vertical misplacement of chest electrodes and

Table 2
Mean sensitivity and specificity of each group.

	Ref	Mean Se	SD	Mean Sp	SD	F1
A	Jekova I. et al., [26]	97.9%	± 0.31	99.1%	± 0.19	98.5%
	Korset al., [20]	95.2%	± 4.25	99.8%	± 0.21	97.4%
	Janet al., [21]	93.2%	± 6.4	99.8%	± 0.11	96.4%
	Bieet al., [28]	88.7%	± 8.80	99.8%	± 0.08	93.9%
	Hedenet al., [19]	71.6%	± 14.01	99.91%	± 0.03	93.8%
	Jekova I. et al., [27]	95.3%	± 0.35	92.2%	± 1.25	93.8%
	Jekova I. et al., [25]	87.0%	± 0.00	97.8%	± 0.00	92.0%
	Hanet al., [30]	56.1%	± 27.7	99.9%	± 0.04	71.8%
		Average = 85.6%	SD = ± 13.5	Average = 98.5%	SD = ± 2.5	
B	Rjoobet al., [23]	79.6%	± 8.6	84.6%	± 5.9	81.6%
	Rjoobet al., [24]	81.5%	± 11.5	81.0%	± 11.0	81.3%
		Average = 80.5%	SD = ± 0.95	Average = 82.8%	SD = ± 1.8	
C	Jekova I. et al., [26]	97.4%	± 1.88	99.2%	± 0.35	98.3%
	Hedenet al., [18]	95.0%	± 0.00	99.95%	± 0.00	97.4%
	Jekova I. et al., [25]	96.8%	± 0.00	97.8%	± 0.00	97.3%
	Hanet al., [30]	93.4%	± 1.05	99.9%	± 0.05	96.5%
	Gregg R. et al., [29]	88.1%	± 3.90	99.7%	± 0.20	93.5%
	Korset al., [20]	83.7%	± 21.31	98.5%	± 2.07	90.4%
	Janet al., [21]	81.5%	± 31.8	99.8%	± 0.18	89.7%
	Han C. et al., [22]	82.5%	± 9.25	97.7%	± 0.20	89.3%
	Hedenet al., [17]	69.0%	± 11.45	99.9%	± 0.01	81.6%
	Hedenet al., [19]	57.6%	± 0.00	99.97%	± 0.00	73.1%
	Bieet al., [28]	54.6%	± 28.09	99.6%	± 0.15	70.5%
		Average = 81.7%	SD = ± 14.5	Average = 99.2%	SD = ± 0.82	

A Represents chest electrode interchanges, B represents chest electrode vertical misplacement and C represents limb electrode interchanges.

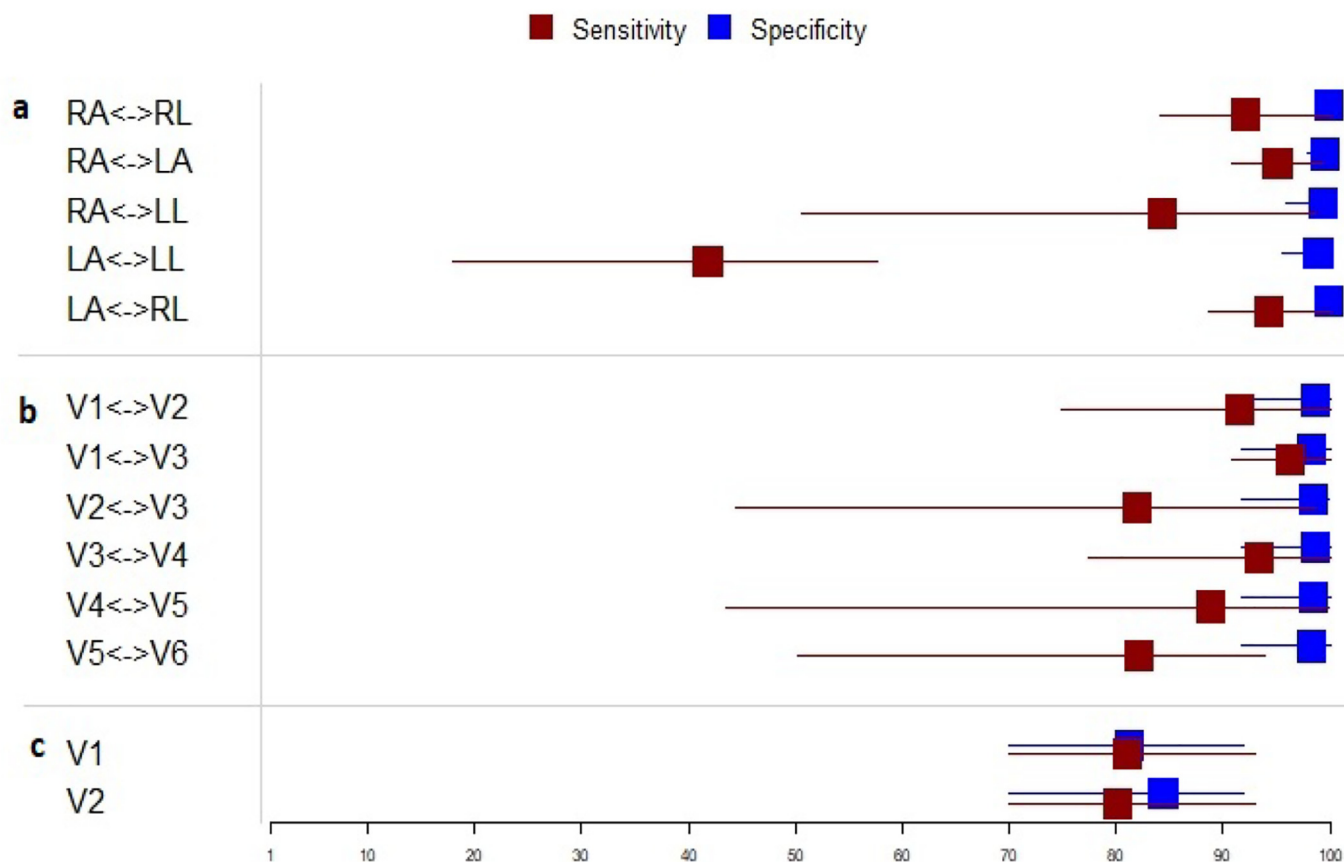


Fig. 2. ML performance in each possible electrode misplacement/interchanges, a: represents limb electrode interchanges, b: represents chest electrodes interchanges and c: represents vertical misplacement of V1 and V2. Right arm (RA), left arm (LA), left leg (LL), right leg (RL).

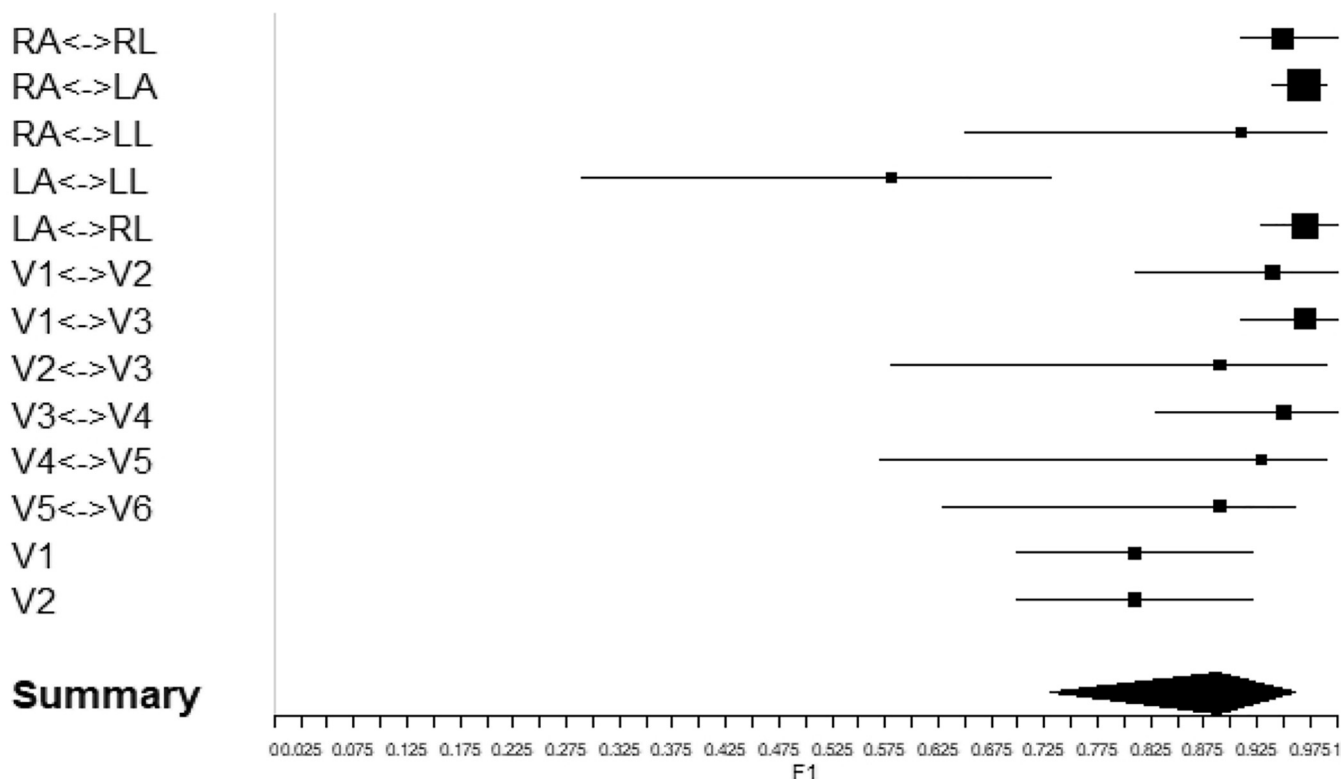


Fig. 3. F1 score of ML for each possible electrode misplacement/interchanges. Right arm (RA), left arm (LA), left leg (LL), right leg (RL).

one study considered chest lead interchange only. The majority of the studies ($n = 12$) used time domain (morphological) features as inputs to the machine learning, while other studies ($n = 2$) used time domain features, statistical features and time-frequency features. Ten studies used data that were extracted from 12 lead ECGs, while four studies considered body surface potential maps (BSPMs) and 12 leads ECGs. All articles could be divided into three domains: 1) chest electrode interchanges, 2) chest electrode misplacement and 3) limb electrode interchange. Results on the performance, methodological details and statistical measures used for the evaluation of performance of ML were provided for each study.

Quality assessment

The quality of an article was evaluated based on scoring system: 1) paper structure, 2) identify research objective clearly, 3) provide sufficient background information, 4) include suitable and acceptable practical experiment, 5) identify dataset clearly, 6) identify and report the results of the experiments clearly, 7) use appropriate methods to analyse the results. Cohen's kappa (at $K = 0.85$) was computed to evaluate the agreement between the two reviewers, and there was an almost perfect agreement for eligibility of studies to be included in the review. Differences between the two reviewers

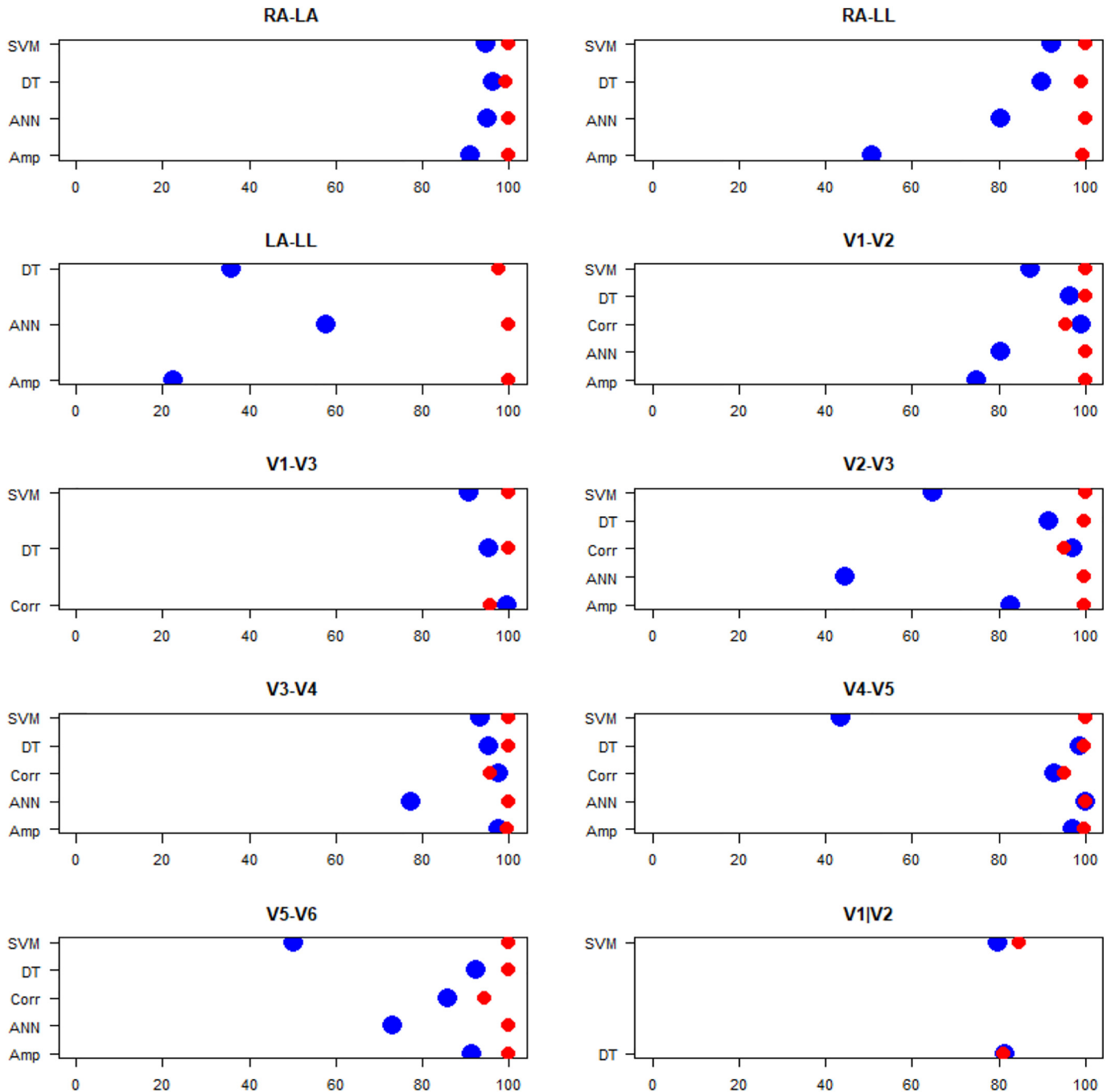


Fig. 4. ML algorithms performance in each scenario of common electrode interchange/misplacement, blue circles represent sensitivity and red circles represent specificity. Decision Tree (DT), correlation (Corr), support vector machine (SVM), artificial neural networks (ANNs), amplitude (Amp), right arm (RA), left arm (LA), left leg (LL), right leg (RL).

were resolved with discussion between reviewers. Risk of bias in the included 14 studies was evaluated using quadas2 [31].

Descriptive summary of results

Sensitivity and specificity were the most frequently used measures to evaluate the performance of ML algorithms to detect misplaced electrodes (where the outcome is binary, i.e. correct electrode position or incorrect electrode position). Sensitivity was used in all studies while specificity was not available in two studies. In the five studies that used DT, the sensitivity ranged from 17.9% to 99.3% and specificity ranged from 86.6% to 100%. When using ANNs, the sensitivity ranged from 44.5% to 99.9% and specificity ranged from 99.8% to 99.9%. In the three other studies that used correlation; the sensitivity ranged from 87.0% to 97.8% while specificity was not provided in these two studies but was mentioned in one study as 91.0%. SVM was used in three studies, and the sensitivity ranged from 56.5% to 93.8% and specificity ranged from 86.6% to 99.9%. A new amplitude threshold algorithm was used in one study, the sensitivity was 20.0%–90.0% and specificity was ~99.8%. Bagged tree was used in two studies, the sensitivity was 84.2%–93.3% and specificity was 92.0%–99.9% and Haisty was used in one study, and the sensitivity was 84.2% and specificity was 99.9%. For chest electrode interchanges, the sensitivity between the studies varied from 44.5% to 99.95% and specificity varied from 91% to 100%. While in limb electrode interchanges, the sensitivity between the studies varied from 20% to 99.3% and specificity varying from 95.6% to 100%. All included studies were divided into three groups: 1) chest electrode interchanges, 2) chest electrode misplacement and 3) limb electrode interchanges (lead reversal). Table 2 below shows mean sensitivity and mean specificity of each group.

In each group, ML performance in electrode misplacement/interchanges was evaluated for each possible electrode misplacement/interchanges according to sensitivity and specificity as shown in Fig. 2 and F1 score as shown in Fig. 3. While Fig. 4 shows each ML algorithm performance particularly in each scenario.

Discussion

The aim of this systematic review and meta-analysis paper is to identify and analyse articles that implement machine learning in the area of automated lead misplacement or interchange recognition. Different articles show the implications of electrode interchanges on decision making in cardiac care and intensive care units which have the highest figures reported for electrode misplacement and how this error can mimic different types of cardiac diseases which could result in a false diagnosis [5,12,32]. Bupp et al. [33], found that electrode misplacement can occur between 40% to 60% of the time. And according to Wegner et al. [34], 36% of chest electrodes are placed outside a radius of 1.25 in. Various methods were developed to prevent lead misplacement, but only 14 articles used ML to detect electrode interchange/misplacement. None of 14 articles considered deep learning (DL) to detect lead interchange/misplacement, while they used traditional ML. The 14 articles were divided into various groups for each analysis to provide accurate results. According to meta-analysis, ML obtained the highest sensitivity and specificity when detecting chest electrode interchanges (switching) compared to limb electrode interchanges and chest electrode misplacement (vertically). Classical ML can detect limb lead interchange with a high degree of performance based on sensitivity and specificity except LA/LL interchange, which is still unresolved with currently low performance (sensitivity<57%) [17,19,20,26]. At the time of writing, there has been no research using deep learning to detect lead misplacement or to improve the performance of LA/LL detection. Changes in P-wave morphology were found to be statistically significant if precordial leads V1 and V2 were misplaced by 2 cm, while morphology changes were not prominent when precordial leads V3, V4 and V5 were misplaced by up to 5 cm from their gold standard location. In addition, the precordial lead V1 was found to be more sensitive

Table 3

Key research questions that have been answered by this systematic review.

Question	Answer
1. Why detecting electrodes misplacement is important? and how interpretation could be affected by electrode misplacement/interchange?	ECGs with electrode misplacement can simulate abnormalities such as ectopic rhythm, chamber enlargement or myocardial infarction, which can lead to significant diagnostic errors such as false positive diagnoses of anterior infarction, ventricular hypertrophy, ischemia, or Brugada syndrome [5,32]. Also, vertical misplacement of V1 and V2 can show a spurious rSr' pattern [35].
2. What are the most sensitive electrodes regarding misplacement and what are the most frequently misplaced electrodes?	V2 is the most sensitive misplaced electrode with regards to the change in the signal followed by V3, V4 and V1 [4]. While V1 and V2 are the most frequent misplaced electrode (>50%) [34].
3. How ML has performed to detect misplacement? And what are the most frequently used ML techniques used to detect electrode misplacement?	According to meta-analysis, ML showed a high sensitivity and specificity to detect electrode misplacement/interchanges, except LA-LL interchange. DT was the most commonly used ML algorithm to detect lead misplacement/interchange (5 out of 14, 35.7%). While the other ML algorithms were used less than four times in the 14 articles (21.4%).
4. What is the best ML algorithm to detect misplacement? And what are the most challenging electrode misplacements to detect using ML?	According to the ten most common lead misplacement/interchange scenarios as shown in Fig. 4, DT obtained the best performance five times out of the ten scenarios. While other ML algorithms obtained the best performance less than 4 times. However, as shown in the meta-analysis, LA-LL is the most challenging electrode misplacement/interchange scenario for ML to solve, it's challenging in intensive care units, especially in the absence of a comparative ECG [36].

to vertical than to horizontal misplacements which is in contrary to other leads which can result in false diagnoses or false negatives [2,5]. Furthermore, Misplacement of V1 and V2 can change the amplitude of R-waves in these leads as per intercostal space away from the correct position, which can result in an interpretation of old anterior myocardial infarction [5] [12]. Hence, healthcare providers should take this into account when recording ECGs [4,6]. Table 3 below shows answers of all key research questions that have been investigated in this study.

Conclusion

This systematic review was conducted to evaluate the performance of published lead interchange detection algorithms. Our findings highlight opportunities for enhancing ECG data quality and clinical decision making through the accurate detection of lead misplacement. Precordial lead waveform changes with the vertical misplacement of the precordial electrodes can cause implications on ECG interpretation. Incorrect electrode placement could change the diagnostic interpretation of the 12-lead ECG and consequently patient treatment. These findings highlight the importance of developing new algorithms such as deep learning to detect electrode misplacement and interchange errors with a high sensitivity and specificity, especially to detect LA-LL interchange.

Author contributors

All authors were responsible for study conception. All were responsible for design, analysis and interpretation of results. All were responsible for revising the manuscript.

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Declaration of Competing Interest

None.

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